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Hyungjin Kim

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Education

The Pennsylvania State University

Ph. D. Candidate, Economics

Korea University

MA, Economics

Korea University

BA, Economics and Financial Engineering

Aug 2019 – Present

State College, PA

Feb 2019

Seoul, South Korea

Feb 2017

Seoul, South Korea

Fields of Interest

International Trade, Industrial Organization

Working Paper

It's Worse than You Think:

Job Market Paper

On the Consequences of the Chip Wars for U.S. Semiconductors

Trade policies during the U.S.-China Chip War have been criticized for harming U.S. semiconductor manufacturers. To formally quantify this effect, I develop a dynamic vertical production network model in which producers compete oligopolistically in both input and output markets, taking into account the market power of oligopolistic input suppliers and technical progress through learning by doing. Applying the model to the global production of memory chips, I find empirical patterns consistent with the model and use them to estimate its key parameters. The estimated model highlights that the export controls not only raise the trade frictions toward China but also unit delivery costs to third countries due to the rise in input cost and the slowdown in technical progress. Furthermore, the effectiveness of the export controls—measured by the increase in China's semiconductor price index—declines each time they are imposed, as U.S. semiconductor producers fall behind in technical progress and capture smaller shares of the output market over time.

Work in Progress

Production Network and Spatial Distribution of Manufacturing

with Mira Rim

Economic activities exhibit a strikingly uneven distribution, traditionally explained by canonical spatial models through agglomeration and congestion forces. While these models effectively capture the spatial distribution of households and corporate headquarters, they fall short in accounting for a crucial determinant of the spatial distribution of production sites: the production network. Our analysis reveals significant heterogeneity in the spatial distribution of manufacturing industries, closely tied to the distribution of factors and markets simultaneously. We develop a multi-sector model where customers' locations and factors drive the spatial distribution of production.

Publication

* Pre-Ph.D.

Kim, Hyungjin, and Jinhyuk Lee. "Collection of personal data with information externality in two-sided markets." *Journal of Economic Theory and Econometrics* 31.3 (2020): 1-22.*

Research Experience

Research Assistant for Nonna Sorokina	2024
<i>The Pennsylvania State University</i>	
Research Assistant for Jonathan Eaton	2022
<i>The Pennsylvania State University</i>	
Research Assistant for Seunghan Yoo	2017 – 2019
<i>Korea University</i>	

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record	Summer 2021
<i>The Pennsylvania State University</i>	
• ECON 302 Intermediate Microeconomic Analysis	
Teaching Assistant	2020 – 2024
<i>The Pennsylvania State University</i>	
• ECON 470 International Trade and Finance	
• ECON 434 International Finance	
• ECON 437 Multinationals and the Globalization of Production	
• ECON 333 International Trade	
• ECON 444 Economics of Corporation	

Research Presentations

2024

- Economics Graduate Student Conference, Washington University in St. Louis
- Comparative Analysis of Enterprise Data, Penn State
- Student brown bag: international trade, Penn State
- Student brown bag: applied micro, Penn State
- American Economic Association annual meeting, San Antonio

2023

- International Economic Association World Congress, Medellin, Colombia
- Midwest International Trade, Georgia Tech
- International Atlantic Economic Society, Philadelphia
- International Trade and Finance Association, University of Richmond
- Student brown bag: applied micro, Penn State
- Student brown bag: international trade, Penn State

- Ph.D. Conference, Centre interuniversitaire de recherche en économie quantitative, Université de Montréal

Awards & Honors

Fellow paper of 33th conference	
<i>International Trade and Finance Association</i>	2023
Doctoral Study Abroad Scholarship	
<i>Yongwoon Foundation</i>	2019
Brain Korea 21 Plus Scholarship	
<i>Korea University</i>	2017-2019

Specialized Skills

Programming Languages: MATLAB, STATA
Language: English (fluent), Korean (native), Japanese (beginner)

References

Prof. Stephen Yeaple (Chair)
 Professor of Economics
 The Pennsylvania State University
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 Email: sry3@psu.edu

Prof. James R. Tybout
 Professor of Economics
 The Pennsylvania State University
 Phone: +1 (814) 865-4259
 Email: jxt32@psu.edu

Prof. Jingting Fan
 Assistant Professor of Economics
 The Pennsylvania State University
 Phone: +1 (814) 865-4592
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